

Changing the lid settings on a laptop

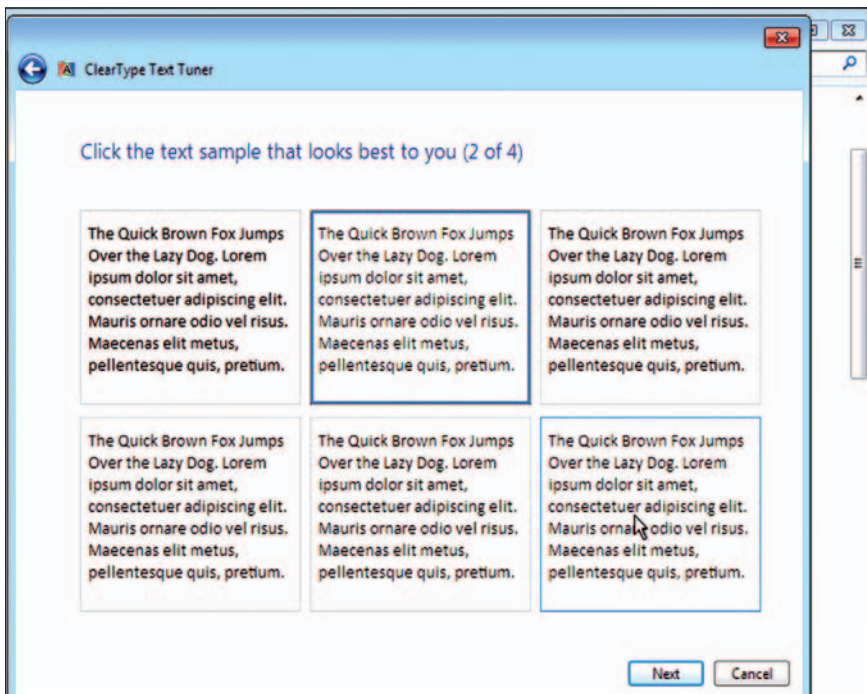
Many laptop users like to use the "do nothing" option every time the lid of the laptop is closed. Go to **Start > Control Panel > All Control Panel Items > Power options**. Change the default plan by going to change plan settings. This will open the Edit plan settings window. Click on Change Advanced power settings. Under Power Buttons and Lid, there will be an option to change the action on closing the lid.

Boosting the performance

If you prefer speed over bells and whistles, go to **Start > Control Panel > All Control Panel items > Performance Information and Tools**. Click on Adjust Visual effects, and select the Adjust for best performance radio button. You can tweak the minute details of the Windows 7 interface here, and go for some features that you like, discarding features that you don't.

Fine tune the font display

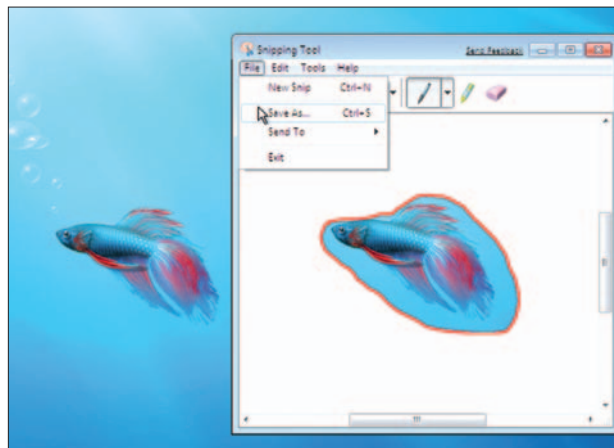
Go to **Start > Control Panel > All Control Panel Items > ClearType Text Tuner**. The text tuner will show a bunch of different text display options, all of which are slightly different. While you are not allowed to manually tweak these options, the approach of choosing one from different versions works as well.



Fine Tuning how Windows 7 displays fonts

Using the Snipping Tool

The Snipping tool can be used to capture any part of the screen, or just a particular window. Go to **Start > Snipping Tool**. In New, select the kind of snipe you want. A rectangular snipe lets you select a rectangular portion of the window. A freeform snipe gives you a pencil like select tool. The windows snip lets you save an entire window as an image file. As soon as a portion of the screen is snipped, Windows 7 lets you save the sniped portion as an image file. The snipped portion will also be copied to the clip board.



The Snipping tool in Windows 7

Calibrate the Monitor

Windows 7 has a monitor calibration walk-through that lets you accurately set the display settings. Go to **Control Panel > All Control Panel Items > Color Management > Advanced > Calibrate Display**. A detailed explanation along with pictures to guide you will let you calibrate the display. At the end of the process, you can revert to your earlier settings.

ADOBE LIGHTROOM 2.2

Adobe Photoshop Lightroom 2.2 is bundled along with Adobe Photoshop CS4, and is a complete photo management utility. This software is meant for professional and enthusiast photographers, who have to handle a large photo collection. There are features available for filing, tagging and filtering photos. Some basic image editing can also be performed through the software, and the photos can be exported directly to Photoshop for further processing.

Add images to Lightroom

Go to **File > Import Photos from Disk** or use the shortcut keys **[Ctrl]+[Shift]+[I]** to import photos stored on the hard drive. To import images directly from a digital camera or a USB drive, go to **File > Import Photos from Device**. Once imported, only the last imported photo will be seen in the catalogue. Click on the All photographs option in the Catalogue window to view all the imported images.

View a quick slideshow

To instantly view a slideshow of all imported images or a selected catalogue, go to **Window > Impromptu Slideshow** or click **[Ctrl]+[Enter]**.

Batch process images

Go to **File > Export**, or use the shortcut keys **[Ctrl]+[Shift]+[E]**. You can set your own presets, use custom settings without presets or use Adobe's presets. For uploading to the web, the email preset is available, which resizes the images to a width of 640 pixels, 50 per cent quality and 72 dpi. To process images for an image hosting service, you can use better quality images. Create a new user preset by clicking